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CRYPTO



Telegram's crypto wallet launches in the US

Telegram is [expanding access](#) to its crypto wallet for its 87 million users in the U.S.

The TON wallet, named because it is built on the TON blockchain, is integrated directly into the Telegram app. By existing within the app, Telegram's crypto wallet is supposed to form an easier onramp for new crypto users.

Telegram has [offered crypto wallets](#) to international users since 2023, though it was unable to roll out in the U.S. until now due to regulatory uncertainty. Telegram says more than [100 million global users](#) activated their wallets last year, which is about 10% of Telegram's 1 billion active users. [Public data](#) shows that about 334,000 transactions are processed on the TON blockchain per day.

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Amanda Silberling

Senior Writer |

Amanda Silberling is a senior writer at TechCrunch covering the intersection of technology and culture. She...

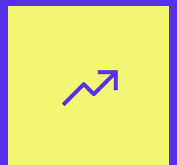
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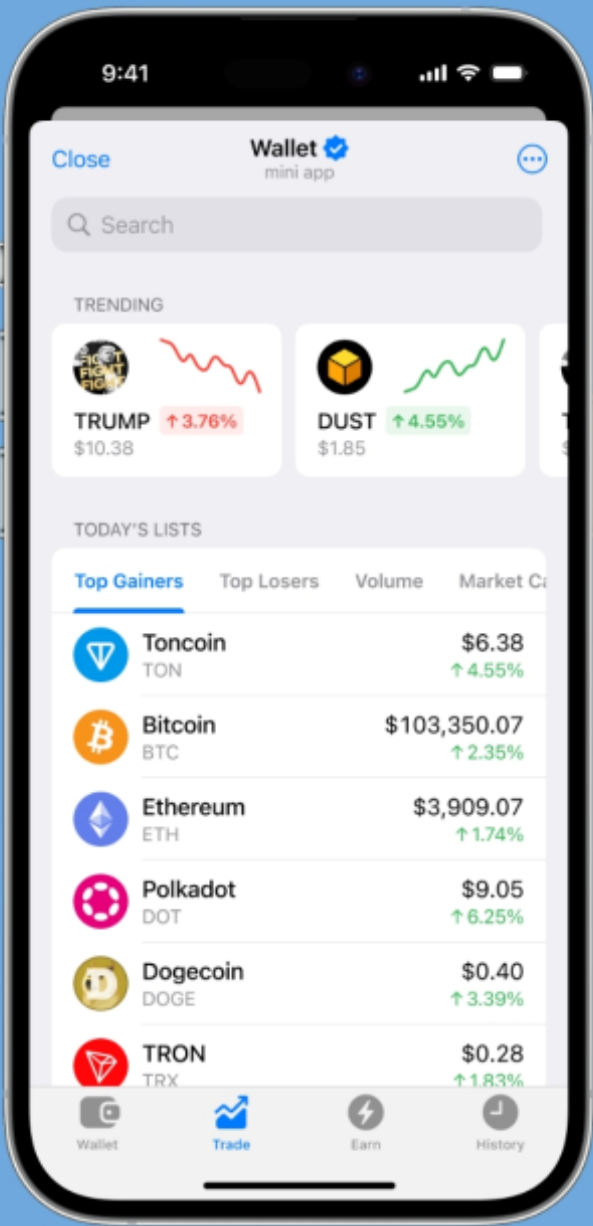


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Crypto wallet integrated with Telegram introduces crypto trading and yield features

Ivan Mehta — 3:14 AM PDT · March 13, 2025

Telegram’s crypto wallet, developed by a third-party company called [The Open Platform](#) (TOP), has

Introduced new features for people who don't just use Telegram as a messaging app. The updates include multi-asset trading and yield functionalities.

[Based on the TON blockchain](#), TOP launched the wallet in 2023. The company reported that over 100 million users have signed up for an account with Wallet on Telegram. Additionally, it noted that most of these users were new to the crypto ecosystem.

The wallet product has primarily been focused on the Toncoin cryptocurrency, which can be used on the Telegram platform to tip creators or pay for minigames and apps. It also supports Bitcoin and USDT (on the TON blockchain). Since the initial launch, the wallet has also gained support of other currencies like Notcoin.

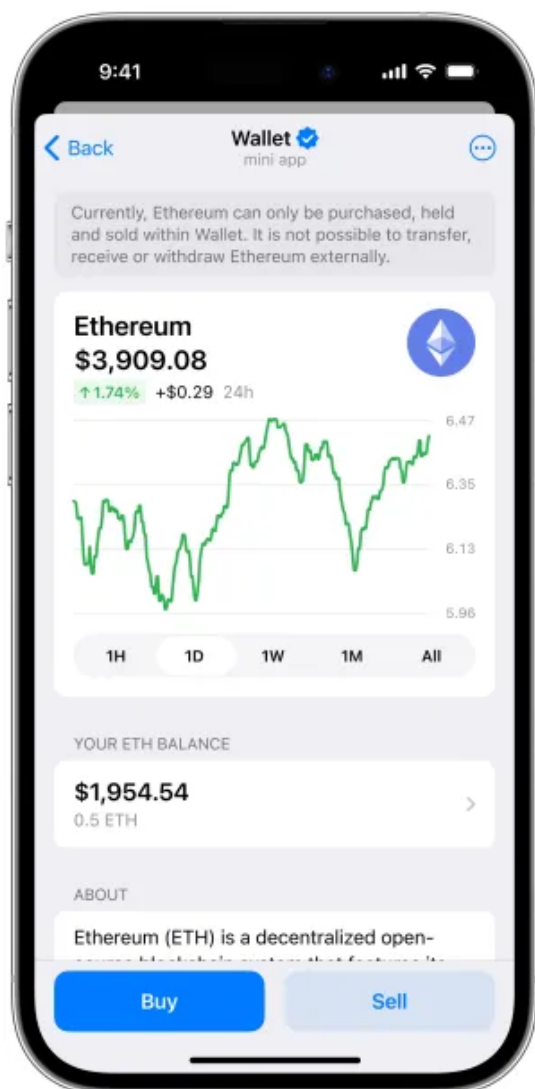


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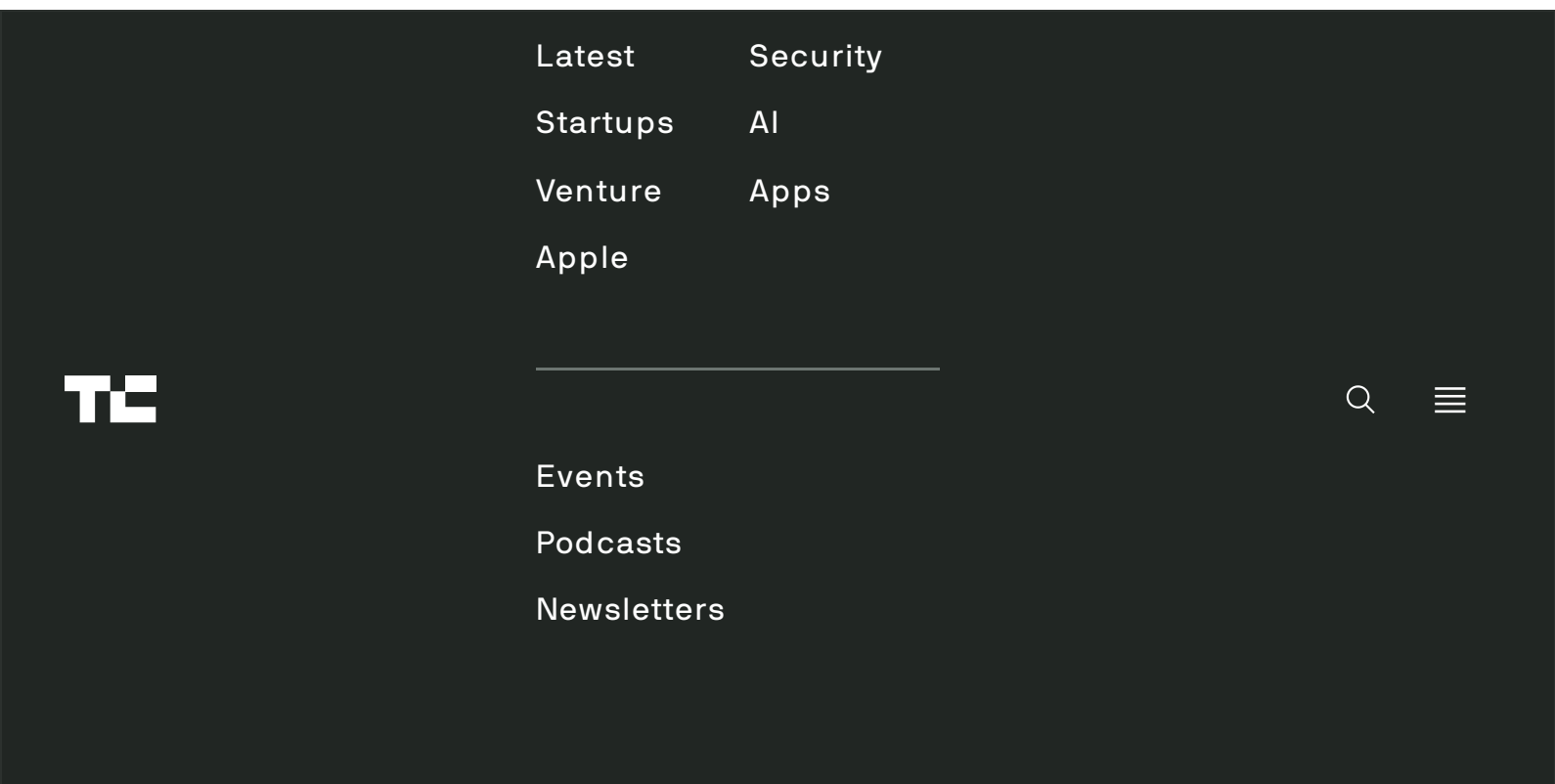
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Following today's update, TOP says that users will be able to buy, sell, or hold crypto without any on-chain deposits. This makes it easier for newer users to get into crypto holding and trading.

The company is also introducing an earning component to the wallet for holding a certain amount of Toncoin. It said that while the average yield is 4%, it will vary based on validators' reward. Later this year, TOP plans to add yields for USDT holdings and launch loyalty programs that would benefit Toncoin holders.

Telegram Wallet has undergone a makeover as well, with a new navigation bar at the bottom and an easy way to switch between the Wallet, Trade, and Earn sections.



“This update enhances Wallet’s functionality, to meet consumers’ expectations for an open and wide market. With current update Wallet now operates as a fully-fledged crypto platform within Telegram while remaining as simple and accessible as ever. We also plan to implement a loyalty program specifically for Toncoin holders, to further boost the adoption of TON Ecosystem,” TOP’s CEO Andrew Rogozov said in a statement.



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The new wallet update will start rolling out to users in March and April. TOP said that some features might be restricted in some countries based on local regulations.

Last December, Telegram founder [Pavel Durov said that the company became profitable](#). The platform has more than [950 million monthly active users](#). Cryptocurrencies have contributed to the company’s bottom line thanks to integrations with [content](#) and [mini app payments](#).

The story was updated after the company's input on yield and self-custody.

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Ivan Mehta

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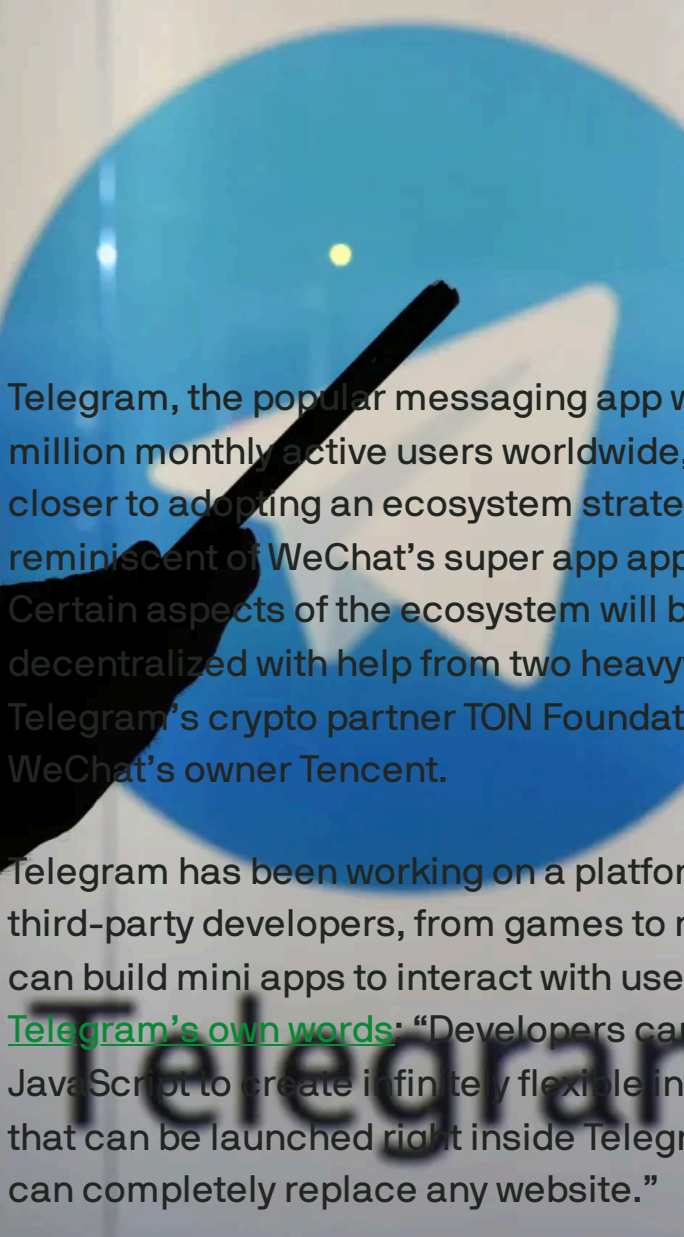
Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously...

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Telegram starts to look like a super app, echoing WeChat



Telegram, the popular messaging app with 800 million monthly active users worldwide, is inching closer to adopting an ecosystem strategy that is reminiscent of WeChat's super app approach. Certain aspects of the ecosystem will be decentralized with help from two heavyweights: Telegram's crypto partner TON Foundation and WeChat's owner Tencent.

Telegram has been working on a platform where third-party developers, from games to restaurants, can build mini apps to interact with users. [In Telegram's own words](#): "Developers can use JavaScript to create infinitely flexible interfaces that can be launched right inside Telegram — and can completely replace any website."

IMAGE CREDITS:

To build out this super app platform, Telegram relies on a network of infrastructure partners both from the established tech world and the crypto space. Among them is The Open Network (TON) Foundation, which lays the blockchain groundwork for Telegram but operates as an independent organization.

This week, TON Foundation announced that it's forged a partnership with Tencent Cloud, which has "already successfully supported TON validators and plans to expand its services further to help meet TON's high compute intensity and network bandwidth needs." Validators, in web3 lingo, are participants that help authenticate transactions in a blockchain network.

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“For example, Telegram games built on TON can benefit from Tencent Cloud’s enriched gaming solution and reference cases,” the announcement says. “For all projects built on TON, Tencent Cloud will offer, subject to approval, a dedicated amount of cloud credits and product discounts, made available through the Tencent Cloud Startup Program.”

Amid [slowing growth in China’s tech industry](#), Tencent has been stepping up its overseas expansion efforts. In recent months, its cloud computing business has been popping up at tech conventions, including crypto conferences. Tencent could potentially reap great rewards from the partnership if Telegram’s mini-app marketplace takes off like its Chinese counterpart.

WeChat has pioneered the mini app model in China and now powers millions of them serving functions from payments, food delivery, e-commerce, and ride-hailing, to driver’s license renewal, just to name a few. With a decentralized payments network, Telegram’s mini-app ecosystem has the potential to reach an even broader spectrum of users around the world.



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Learning from WeChat's playbook

Even though Tencent Cloud won't be TON's exclusive cloud provider according to TechCrunch's knowledge, it appears that the partners stand to gain from their synergies.

"Given the similarities between WeChat mini apps and Telegram mini apps, we believe that mini app developers from WeChat who are currently using Tencent's cloud service will begin to build on TON," Justin Hyun, head of growth at TON Foundation, told TechCrunch.

It's unclear how many developers building for WeChat's China users are able to capture the diverse needs of Telegram's international community. Creators of mobile games might have the most transferrable skills, given many of them are already marketing in overseas markets. Given Telegram is blocked in China, many developers will

have to familiarize themselves with the app before they can devise meaningful applications for the platform.

The developers would also need to learn the programming languages of blockchain apps, which might actually be an easier barrier to overcome than the process of understanding the economic incentives that facilitate decentralized applications.

A partnership with Tencent, however, could offer insights into enticing people to use a messenger for a whole array of other purposes. Importantly, payment functionality played a critical role in WeChat's early rise as it instilled a habit among users to make daily transactions through the chat app.

While WeChat makes its in-house payments system the default option and turned it into a cash cow for Tencent, Telegram has [integrated with 20 payments solutions](#) and [takes no commission](#) through its Bot Payments API. Aside from mature solutions like Google Pay or Apple Pay, Telegram also recently welcomed a [self-custodial wallet](#) that is independently developed by The Open Platform (TOP) using the TON blockchain. Having a crypto wallet can potentially bring a wide range of transaction scenarios to regions where centralized online payments aren't available.

It will be fascinating to witness what lessons Telegram and TON take from WeChat and how a mini-app platform with a decentralized twist unfolds.

Telegram adds self-custodial crypto wallet worldwide, excluding the US



Telegram, the popular chat app with 800 million monthly active users, is getting a self-custodial crypto wallet. The move is set to solidify its presence in the vibrant crypto community that has emerged from its chat platform and can potentially help drive the masses into the crypto space. Telegram and TON Foundation jointly announced the ... Continue reading

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